Gifts, Repayments, Sales and Name Changes

Everyday money moves to notice and write down while Mom's care is being paid for, without judging what any of them means.

Since Mom's care began, money has moved in small ways: a bill your sister covered, a check to a grandchild, a car that changed hands. None of it is unusual, and most of it isn't written down anywhere.

This guide names fifteen everyday things worth noticing and, for each, what to write down. Notice and record. Don't interpret. Being on this list doesn't mean anything is wrong with a payment. What any of it means for Medicaid depends on Mom's state and her situation, and that is a question for a professional, who can answer it better with your notes in front of them. What to record (dates, amounts, reasons and the people involved) follows the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's guide for people who manage someone else's money. The list of what to notice is ours, taken from this step of the roadmap.

Paying for care

1 **The monthly care bill** [1]

NOTICE The amount, what it covers, and any extra charges beyond the basic rate.

WRITE DOWN The date, the total, the extras on their own line, and which account paid it.

2 **A bill someone else covered** [2]

NOTICE A relative who paid a care bill, a pharmacy charge or a repair from their own pocket.

WRITE DOWN Who paid, what for, the date and the amount, and whether anyone expects to be paid back.

3 **Cash** [2]

NOTICE Cash taken out of Mom's accounts, and things paid for in cash.

WRITE DOWN The date, the amount and what it was for. Keep the receipt, even for a small expense.

Money going to people

4 **Gifts** [2]

NOTICE Birthday and holiday checks, help with a grandchild's tuition, a contribution to a relative's expenses.

WRITE DOWN The date, the amount, who it went to and the occasion. No commentary.

5 **Repayments and payments to family** [2]

NOTICE A relative paid back for something they covered, or a family member paid for help they give.

WRITE DOWN The date, the amount, what it was for, and any paper that goes with it.

6 **Debts and bills paid off**

NOTICE A credit card cleared, a loan settled, a bill that had been waiting.

WRITE DOWN What was owed, to whom, the date it was paid and from which account.

Names and ownership

7 A name added to or taken off something [2]

NOTICE A change of owner or signer on a bank account, a deed, a car title or a policy, done or being talked about.

WRITE DOWN What changed, the date, whose names were on it before and whose are on it now.

8 Something sold or handed on

NOTICE The car nobody drives, furniture, jewelry, a piece of property: sold, given to a relative, or about to be.

WRITE DOWN What it was, who has it now, the date, and what was paid for it, if anything.

9 Money moved between accounts [2]

NOTICE An account closed, two accounts combined, money moved into an account with someone else's name on it.

WRITE DOWN The date, the amount, the account it left and the account it went to.

Larger spending

10 Home repairs and personal purchases

NOTICE A repair to the house, equipment for Mom, a larger purchase made for her.

WRITE DOWN What it was, the date, the cost, and where the receipt or contract is.

Policies, products and proposals

11 Insurance policies [3]

NOTICE A policy cashed in, borrowed against, changed or allowed to lapse, or a letter from an insurance company.

WRITE DOWN Which policy, what happened or was proposed, the date, and where the papers are.

12 A financial product someone suggests [4]

NOTICE An annuity or another product raised by a relative, a salesperson, a seminar or a mailing.

WRITE DOWN Who suggested it, their title and company, the date, and what papers you were handed.

13 Retirement accounts

NOTICE Money taken out of a retirement account, whether it comes out regularly or just once.

WRITE DOWN The date, the amount and what it was used for.

14 Funeral and burial arrangements

NOTICE An arrangement Mom already has with a funeral home, or one that is being discussed.

WRITE DOWN Whether one exists, with whom, the date, and where the contract is.

What people say

15 Rules and advice people offer [5]

NOTICE “It all has to be spent.” “You should move it.” Said by a relative, a friend, someone at the care provider, someone online.

WRITE DOWN What was said, who said it and when. Then turn it into a question.

When a note isn't enough

If something on this list hasn't happened yet (a gift, a repayment, a sale, a new name on an account, a product someone would like Mom to buy), that is the time to ask as well as write. Bring it to your Medicaid planner, whose part on this roadmap is to review how Medicaid rules may apply to a proposed financial action before it is taken. Anything that needs legal review goes to an elder law attorney, and an insurance or financial product to a licensed insurance or financial professional. For things already done, the note is the whole job: write them down and bring them.

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't say what any of these mean for Medicaid or for Mom's eligibility, whether any of them is a problem, or what your family should do about them. It doesn't grade your family's situation, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice. The professionals do the interpreting, and they do it better with your dated notes in front of them.

Ready for the next step?

You've noticed and noted, with dates and names, without having to judge any of it. The planning interview gives those notes somewhere to go: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Costs of Care
2. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Managing Someone Else's Money: Help for agents under a power of attorney
3. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Using Life Insurance to Pay for Long-term Care
4. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Know your financial adviser
5. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Who Pays for Long-Term Care?